JAVIER LERA

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Academic Positions

Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, Universidad de Cantabria. 2024–present

Postdoc Researcher, Valdecilla Biomedical Research Institute – IDIVAL, Santander. 2021–2024

Lecturer, Department of Economics, Universidad de Cantabria. 2018–2021; 2024

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Universidad de Cantabria.
Thesis: Essays in Health Economics: Healthcare Utilization.
Supervisors: David Cantarero Prieto and Marta Pascual Sáez.
Cum Laude. 2021

M.Sc. in Economics: Instruments of Economic Analysis,
Universidad de Cantabria. 2017

Bachelors Degree in Economics,
Universidad de Cantabria. 2016

Master in Management and Planning of Long-Term Care Centres and Services,
Universidad de Cantabria. 2023

Master in Management of Health Services,
Universidad de Cantabria. 2021

Research

Research Interests: Health Economics; Public Economics; Economics of Ageing and Long-Term Care; Applied Microeconometrics; Public Policy Evaluation.

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

[1] Peiró-Pérez, R., García-Sierra, M., Peso-Moreno, F. J., Longo-Abril, G., García-Cubillana de la Cruz, P., Rodríguez-Acuña, R., Jiménez-Pernett, J., Lupiañez-Castillo, A., Cabeza-Irigoyen, E., Planas-Juan, T., Núñez-Jiménez, C., Barreda-Gutiérrez, M., **Lera, J.**, Cantarero-Prieto, D., et al. (2026). "Invertir la tendencia de la obesidad infantil: ocho experiencias de promoción de la salud en zonas en situación de vulnerabilidad. Proyecto Health4EUKids." *Revista Española de Salud Pública*, 100, e202610066. DOI

[2] **Lera, J.**, Pinillos-Franco, S., and Cantarero-Prieto, D. (2026). "Social capital, partnership transitions and depressive symptoms in later life: Evidence from Europe." *Applied Economics*. DOI

[3] Pinillos-Franco, S., **Lera, J.**, and Cantarero-Prieto, D. (2026). "Parental permissiveness toward alcohol and tobacco and its consequences for adolescent vaping behaviors." *BMC Public Health*. DOI

[4] **Lera, J.**, Cantarero-Prieto, D., and Pinillos-Franco, S. (2026). "Pay attention to your social capital! It

determines your health: an analysis for the elderly in Europe." *Health Economics Review*, 16, 18. DOI

[5] García, E., **Lera, J.**, Cantarero-Prieto, D., Blázquez-Fernández, C., Expósito, A., and Rodríguez-Valcarce, A. (2026). "Humanization in palliative care through art: A Social Return on Investment (SROI) analysis of ProArt." *Revista Galega de Economía*, 35(2). DOI

[6] Barreda, M., Cantarero-Prieto, D., Coca, D., Delgado, A., Lanza-León, P., **Lera, J.**, Montalbán, R., and Pérez, F. (2025). "Transforming healthcare with chatbots: Uses and applications—A scoping review." *Digital Health*. DOI

[7] Pinillos-Franco, S., Cantarero-Prieto, D., and **Lera, J.** (2024). "Feeling discriminated means poor self-perceived health: A gender analysis using SHARE." *International Journal of Health Economics and Management*. DOI

[8] Cantarero-Prieto, D., Lanza-León, P., Moreno-Mencía, P., **Lera, J.**, González, F., González-Rodríguez, I., and Blázquez-Fernández, C. (2023). "Coronavirus fear of contagion and compliance with social distancing measures: Evidence for a sample of a Spanish university community." *PeerJ*. DOI

[9] Cava, P., San Román, J., Barreiro, P., Candel, F. J., Álvarez-Timón, F. J., Melero, D., Coya, N., Guillén, R., Cantarero-Prieto, D., **Lera, J.**, et al. (2023). "Temporal Series Analysis of Population Cycle Threshold Counts as a Predictor of Surge in Cases and Hospitalizations during the SARS-CoV-2 Pandemic." *Viruses*, 15(2), 421. DOI

[10] Cantarero-Prieto, D., Lanza-León, P., Moreno-Mencía, P., Blázquez-Fernández, C., **Lera, J.**, González-Diego, F. J., and González-Rodríguez, I. (2023). "Change in eating habits during the Spanish COVID-19 pandemic lockdown: Evidence for a sample of university community." *PeerJ*, 11, e14244. DOI

[11] Cantarero-Prieto, D., **Lera, J.**, Lanza-León, P., Barreda-Gutiérrez, M., Guillem-Porta, V., Castelo-Branco, L., and Martín-Moreno, J. M. (2022). "The Economic Burden of Localized Prostate Cancer and Insights Derived from Cost-Effectiveness Studies of the Different Treatments." *Cancers*, 14(17), 4088. DOI

[12] **Lera, J.**, Pascual-Sáez, M., and Cantarero-Prieto, D. (2021). "Socioeconomic Inequality in the Use of Long-Term Care among European Older Adults: An Empirical Approach Using the SHARE Survey." *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health*, 18(1), 20. DOI

[13] Cantarero-Prieto, D., Pascual-Sáez, M., and **Lera, J.** (2020). "Healthcare Utilization and Healthy Lifestyles among Elderly People Living in Southern Europe: Recent Evidence from SHARE." *Atlantic Economic Journal*, 48(1), 53–66. DOI

Other Publications

Books and Book Chapters

[1] **Lera, J.** and Barreda, M. (2025). "Evaluación colaborativa en Statistical Methods in Economics and Business: Una experiencia con estudiantes internacionales." In *Experiencias que enseñan: saberes aplicados sobre proyectos, normas y memorias*, pp. 450–465. Madrid: Dykinson.

[2] Cantarero-Prieto, D. and **Lera, J.** (2023). "Las nuevas perspectivas del Edadismo y de la Economía de la longevidad." In *La fiscalidad del envejecimiento*. Aranzadi.

[3] Cantarero-Prieto, D. and **Lera, J.** (2022). "Relación entre el edadismo y el desarrollo especializado en sectores relacionados con la economía silver: presente y futuro." In *Economía y longevidad: Seminario Ageingnomics 2021*, pp. 50–68. Fundación MAPFRE.

[4] **Lera, J.**, Pascual-Sáez, M., and Cantarero-Prieto, D. (2021). "¿Podemos mejorar los cuidados de larga duración de las personas mayores en la era COVID-19? Un análisis empírico a nivel europeo." In *Envejecimiento y COVID-19: Seminario Ageingnomics 2020*. Fundación MAPFRE.

Research Projects

European and International Research Projects

HOPE4Kids – Holistic Oncological Palliative Care 4 Europe's Kids
EU4Health Programme, European Commission. IDIVAL (EU24/24).
PI: María Jesús Cabero Pérez; Co-PI: David Cantarero Prieto. 2025–2029

SAM – Smart Digital Twin for Social Prescribing in Primary Healthcare
Interreg Sudoe, European Commission. Universidad de Cantabria.
PI: Olga de Cos Guerra. 2025–2028

Health4EUkids – Joint Action for the Implementation of Best Practices and Research Results on Healthy Lifestyles for Health Promotion and Prevention of Non-Communicable Diseases and Risk Factors
EU4Health Programme, European Health and Digital Executive Agency (HaDEA). IDIVAL.
PI: David Cantarero Prieto. 2022–2025

TIMELY – A Patient-Centered Early Risk Prediction, Prevention, and Intervention Platform to Support the Continuum of Care in Coronary Artery Disease Using eHealth and Artificial Intelligence
Horizon 2020, European Commission. Grant Agreement No. 101017424.
Fundación Marqués de Valdecilla / IDIVAL. 2021–2024

Other Competitive Research Projects

Design of a Methodology for the Evaluation of Programmes and Services of the Cantabrian Employment Service: Mapping of Programmes and Services and Proposal for the Evaluation of Active Labour Market Policies
Government of Cantabria. Universidad de Cantabria.
PI: David Cantarero Prieto. 2025–2026

Predictive Analysis of Factors Associated with Therapeutic Non-Adherence in Primary Care: Proactive Intervention Model with Impact Evaluation
Fundación Marqués de Valdecilla / IDIVAL.
PI: Federico Talledo Pelayo. 2023–2025

Cost-Effectiveness of a Robotic Voice Tool for Direct Communication between the Health Service and Patients, Compared with Traditional Communication
Government of Cantabria (SUBVTC-2023-0021). Fundación Marqués de Valdecilla / IDIVAL.
PI: David Cantarero Prieto. 2023–2024

Economic Evaluation of the Introduction of Continuous Glucose Monitoring in the Cantabrian Health Service
IDIVAL. 2019–2021

Modelling and Sensitivity Analysis in the Evaluation of Public Policies in Health Economics
SODERCAN. Universidad de Cantabria.
PIs: David Cantarero Prieto and Marta Pascual Sáez. 2019–2020

Knowledge Transfer and Contract Research

Design and Development of the Digitalisation Indicators System for Cantabria
ICT Cluster Association of Cantabria. 2026

Consultancy and Specialised Advisory Services for the Analysis of Productivity and Workforce Sizing in Hospitals of the Cantabrian Health Service
Cantabrian Health Service. 2025

Review and Updating of the Integrated Territorial Strategy for the Besaya Region
Government of Cantabria. 2025

Instruments to Promote R&D&I in Cantabria
Colegio de Economistas de Cantabria. 2024–2025

Research on PROMs and PREMs in Migraine
Lundbeck España. 2024–2025

Economic Evaluation and Social Return of a Diagnostic Algorithm for the Detection of Undiagnosed Cardiac Amyloidosis
Fundación San Juan de Dios. 2019

Teaching Experience

Current Teaching

Redistributive Economic Policies
B.Sc. in Economics, Universidad de Cantabria 2026–present

Financial Mathematics
B.Sc. in Economics and B.Sc. in Business Administration, Universidad de Cantabria 2026–present

Economics of Social Expenditure
B.Sc. in Economics, Universidad de Cantabria 2026–present

Selected Previous Teaching

Statistical Methods in Economics and Business
International Programme (English-taught course), Universidad de Cantabria 2018–2026

Statistical Methods in Economics and Business
B.Sc. in Economics, Universidad de Cantabria 2024–2026

Statistics I
B.Sc. in Economics and B.Sc. in Business Administration, Universidad de Cantabria 2024–2026

Statistics II
B.Sc. in Business Administration, Universidad de Cantabria 2024–2026

Mathematics for Economists
B.Sc. in Business Administration, Universidad de Cantabria 2024–2025

Public Economics
B.Sc. in Economics, Universidad de Cantabria 2023–2024

European Economic Integration
B.Sc. in Economics and B.Sc. in Business Administration, Universidad de Cantabria 2020–2023

European Economic Policy
B.Sc. in Economics, Universidad de Cantabria 2020–2021

Foreign Trade Techniques
B.Sc. in Economics, Universidad de Cantabria 2022–2023

Financial Mathematics / Mathematics of Finance
B.Sc. in Economics and B.Sc. in Business Administration, Universidad de Cantabria 2018–2025

Undergraduate Thesis Supervision

Perceptions of Crime in Spain: Evolution, Social Differences, and Associated Factors	2025–26
Economic Growth and Loneliness in European Union Countries	2025–26
An Analysis of the Factors Affecting the Gender Gap in Academic Achievement	2024–25
An Analysis of the Electricity Market	2024–25
Social Expenditure in Times of COVID: Theory and Empirical Evidence	2023–24
The Influence of Personal Income Tax on Inequality and Income Distribution: An Economic Analysis	2023–24
Applying European Personal Income Tax Models: A Microsimulation for Spain (Co-supervisor)	2023–24
The Impact of COVID-19 and Social Expenditure on Housing Affordability in Europe	2023–24
The Common Agricultural Policy (CAP): An Analysis of Labour Productivity after the 2013 Reform	2020–21
Historical Evolution of Poverty: An Analysis of Poverty and Social Exclusion in Spain	2020–21
The European Banking Union and Its Effects on Credit to European Households	2020–21
Social Expenditure and the Well-Being of Older People in the European Union	2019–20